

Application for the 2027 Investment Banking Spring Week Programme - London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am fascinated by the global economy and international financial markets because they are constantly determined by the interactions of numerous players and by economic and business factors, such as individual corporate decisions and capital allocation. It is precisely these interactions that interest me most, as no two market situations are alike and new information continually influences the market. I am notably impressed by the capital markets, as they channel capital to where it can most effectively encourage long-term development and innovation. The relationship between global developments and analytical decision-making methods motivates me to deepen my comprehension of market processes, such as investment processes.

My career to date has been defined by a drive to continually measure myself against the best, thereby constantly developing my competencies and, through initiative and discipline, achieving above-average performance. This was already evident in competitive football, where I was voted the best player out of around 140 participants at a Real Madrid summer camp, thereby qualifying for the national Real Madrid try-outs. I apply this same standard of excellence in my academic life as well. For instance, I was awarded a scholarship from e-fellows.net, received recognition for my exceptional commitment to the Democracy Club, and came second in the 2022 Baden-Württemberg State Parliament competition. Through these projects, I improved my communication skills, teamwork, and sense of personal responsibility, especially by planning and organizing school events such as the 'Night of Democracy'. My great interest in finance led me, even before I began my degree, to undertake an internship in auditing at Baker Tilly, where I gained initial insights into annual accounts and balance sheet analysis, as well as into the workings of an internationally active professional services firm. At the same time, I joined the Helvetian Investment Club before starting my degree to strengthen my analytical reasoning skills and interact with like-minded students. I will be taking the next step in my academic development at the University of St Gallen, having completed its exacting admissions process. This test enabled me to display my logical thinking and quantitative problem-solving abilities, notably under significant time pressure and the need to perform. My qualities, in particular my analytical mindset, resilience, and performance-oriented approach, have had a strong impact on me and reinforced my ability to add value, even in a demanding, performance-oriented environment such as the Jefferies Spring Week Programme.

"It is easy to buy stocks and bonds, do deals or change jobs. It is difficult to be successful, to have the discipline of a high bar in decisions and to persevere through thick and thin times" (Brian Friedman & Rich Handler). For me, this quote represents an aspect of Jefferies' working culture that resonates with me as I value working alongside people who share my commitment to discipline and high standards. I am also fascinated by Jefferies' organisational structure. Jefferies' flat and entrepreneurial structure, which offers junior professionals meaningful exposure to senior bankers and complex transactions, is particularly appealing to me. The resulting opportunities to learn and take on responsibility at an early stage are particularly exciting for me as I seek to build a career in investment banking. Furthermore, Jefferies stands out for its integrated approach, linking advisory, financing and market insights to provide a comprehensive understanding of the entire transaction.

In conclusion, I am confident that I meet the requirements for the Jefferies Investment Banking Spring Week Programme. My motivation stems from my passion for capital markets, notable sporting achievements, and a strong academic background. I am keen to deepen my understanding of economic interrelationships and decision-making, and further develop my resilience, discipline, and analytical thinking.

I look forward to contributing and learning from the programme.

Yours sincerely,
Jacob Keintzel